Make decision boundaries visible

Choose the agreement for each decision. These are practical working options, not a universal maturity ladder.

DECIDE WITHIN BOUNDS

The person chooses the method or routine decision within named limits. Agree what to share afterwards.

Example: choose the update's layout and contact milestone owners.

RECOMMEND, THEN AGREE

The person brings options and a recommendation. The named approver decides before action.

Example: propose a change to an already agreed project date.

RETAIN WITH NAMED OWNER

Someone else holds this decision. Name them and the route; do not give responsibility without authority.

Example: customer commitments and budget remain with Maya.

They can decide / Within these limits / Update me when

Approval needed / Who decides / How to reach them

Always name the actual decision. "Use your judgement" and "check everything with me" leave too much unclear.

Your one-page delegation brief

Task: _____ Owner: _____ Agreed on: _____

PURPOSE & RESULT / Who uses it? What must it achieve?

DONE & DUE / Criteria, required checks and deadline

FIT & CAPACITY / Skill, hours, learning and agreed trade-off

DECISIONS / They decide; approval needed; retained owner

SUPPORT / Access, resources, learning and who provides them

CHECK-IN / When; what to bring; early-warning trigger and route

FIRST STEP & CONFIRMATION / Their summary; next action; owner/date; final reviewer; backup

Your check-in and ownership plan

Use only the checkpoints needed for this task. Agree changes openly; avoid both constant checking and disappearing.

When / channel	What evidence or question?	Decision / owner / next action
Start		
Agreed checkpoint		
Completion / review		

If this risk or blocker appears / Contact who, how and by when?

If I am unavailable / Agreed backup / What can continue?

Step support down when the criteria are being met and the person agrees the next arrangement is workable. Add support when risk, complexity or learning needs change; explain the reason.